

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Those were the days ...



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about friendship and relationships.
- I can talk about habits in the past.
- I can talk about people's past experiences.

Ask your partner:

- What is a fond memory you have from your childhood?
- Where did you use to hang out? What did you do there?





Let's Explore!

Sally's interview with her neighbor, George, continues. What does he say about **back then***?

* "Back then" means at a certain point in the past.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally: What kind of stories can you tell me?

George: Oh! The stories I could tell you! ... I remember this one time in high school, my friends and I snuck out of class and drove to the next town. Gordie and I were the only ones with driver's licenses and cars, so we used to drive everyone everywhere.

There was a roller skating rink in the next town over - all the cool kids used to hang out there. One day we drove out there and ended up getting lost on the back roads. Of course there was no GPS back then, so we had to hope we'd come across a main road so we could get back onto the highway. Luckily we ran into a rancher and he pointed us in the right direction! We were traveling the wrong way the whole time!

We made it back in time for dinner. My mother would always have it ready at 6:30 on the dot. I've never been as happy as I was when I was a teenager. Those were the days ... young, innocent and free!





Let's Practice!

Those were the days*, according to George.

*"Those were the days" is an expression you use when you think back fondly on your past.

Instructions: Read the sentences and complete them by choosing the correct answer.

- 1) Gordie and I _____ everyone _____.
 - a. use to drive, everywhere
 - b. used to drive, everywhere
 - c. used drive, every where
- 2) My mother _____ dinner ready at 6:30 _____.
 - a. would had, on the dot
 - b. would has, on dot
 - c. would have, on the dot
- 3) All the cool kids _____ hang out at the _____.
 - a. used to, roller skating ring
 - b. used to, roller skating rink
 - c. use to, roller skating rink



Let's Practice!

Is there a connection to the present?

Instructions: Read the sentences and write them into the correct category.

I've never been as happy as I was when I was a teenager. / He's become a successful rancher. / One day, we drove to the next town. / We've stayed in touch over the years. / I've done so many fun things in my life. / We made it back in time for dinner. / Gordie and I were the only ones with driver's licenses and cars. / There was no GPS back then.

Finished in the past

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Connection to the present

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Extension Activity

Write a story about when you were a child.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a story from when you were a child.
- Write a detailed description of the event.
- Try to include phrasal verbs.
- Exchange your story with a partner.
- Discuss your stories with each other.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about a childhood memory.

☐ ☐

I read my partner's story and consider any similarities between mine and theirs.

☐ ☐

I discuss the stories with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **roller skating rink** (noun): a place where people gather to roller skate
e.g. There was a roller skating rink in the next town over.
- **back roads** (noun): small road that doesn't have much traffic on it
e.g. We ended up getting lost on the back roads.
- **to sneak out** (verb): to leave a place secretly
e.g. My friends and I snuck out of class and drove to the next town.
- **to come across** (verb): to unexpectedly meet someone
e.g. We came across a farmer.
- **to end up** (verb): to eventually become
e.g. We ended up getting lost.
- **on the dot** (expression): exactly
e.g. Dinner was always read at 6:00 on the dot.
- **rancher** (noun): a farmer that owns horses or cattle
e.g. Luckily, we met a rancher.
- **innocent** (adjective): pure; not corrupted
e.g. Those were the days: young, innocent and free!





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs The Simple Past

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about an action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** connected to the present.

It is common to mix both the Simple Past and Present Perfect when you tell anecdotes or reminisce about the past.

When you can use the Present Perfect there is a connection between what happened in the past and now. You use time markers like *for, just, ever* with the Present Perfect.

When you use the past simple, the time is always past. You use time markers with the past like: *then, ago, yesterday, when I was ...* with the Simple Past.

Examples:

- *I've never been as happy as I was when I was a teenager.*
- *We drove to the next town over.*





Learning Points

Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs are common in spoken English. There are many phrasal verbs. It is good to think of them like vocabulary. You need to memorize them in order to be able to use them.

There are some grammar rules you use with phrasal verbs.

1. A phrasal verb contains a verb and a participle (a preposition or an adverb).

Some common particles used in phrasal verbs are: *in, out, on, up, into, around, at, off, down, away*.

2. Some phrasal verbs are separable (the object can come between the verb and the particle)

take off

take off your coat, take your coat off

put in

put in some time, put some time in

3. Some phrasal verbs are inseparable (the object can only come after the participle).

sneak out

run into

end up

catch up